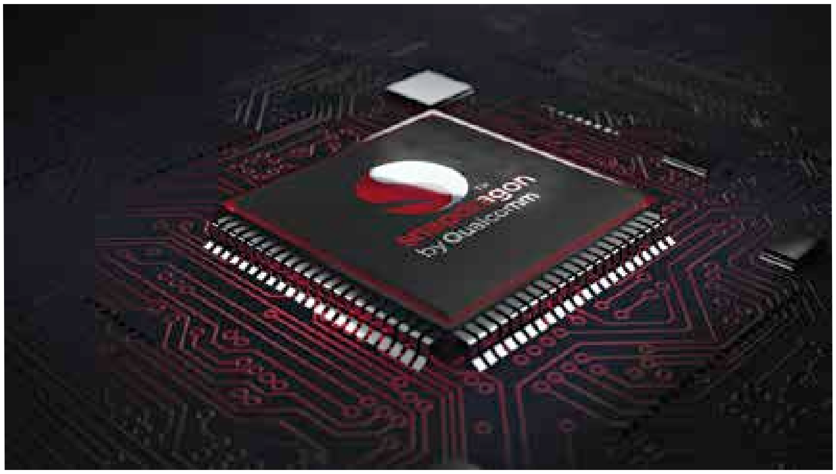
count lens will look better. While more megapixels do mean the camera can capture more detail, the quality of the image or its ability to capture more light is not impacted by the number of megapixels on the lens. Rather, it can work against it, as a higher number of megapixels being crammed in a small-sized sensor could result in a downgrade in terms of the low-light performance of a lens.

As such, the next time you're being told to buy a phone based on the high-megapixel count of its cameras, don't forget that key components of a picture such as contrast, colour, dynamic range, or detail, are never dependent on the megapixel count of the lens, and instead depend on the size of the aperture and when it comes to smartphones, the computational photography algorithms available on the device.

More cores and higher clockspeed on a chipset is not always better

One of the biggest marketing traps that you need to avoid when buying a phone is falling for the notion that more cores on a CPU are indicative of better performance on the phone. Just like megapixels where more doesn't necessarily mean better image quality, more cores also don't necessarily mean a faster processor. Rather than more cores, the information you should be on the lookout for is just how effective and efficient the cores available on a chip are. From the clock speed to the chip's design and architecture, there are multiple factors that define how a chip will perform on a phone.

There's also another big factor that users should be on the lookout for, the ability of the operating system to effectively use all the cores at hand. Generally, most apps are developed to use one or two cores at the max. So, in such cases, having a chipset with two performance cores and six efficiency cores, rather than a chipset with more performance cores and less efficiency cores, is typically preferable.



Peak Brightness

Another marketing term that's meant to confuse the user is the oft-repeated talk of the Peak Brightness of a phone. While it's true the peak brightness rating of a panel can help give you an idea of the display performance of a phone, it is also important to note that it can be highly misleading when the information is not shared properly.

Most flagship phones these days advertise high peak brightness ratings that go upwards of 1500 nits. But what their marketing teams do not advertise is that this very impressive number can only be achieved by lighting up pixels on around 1 per cent of the window of the panel and that too for a very short period. The average typical brightness of modern-day flagship phone displays max out at around 700-800 nits, and for mid-range phones this number goes down to even 400 nits.

Curved display

This is a conflicting one, mostly because some of us here, honestly, love curved displays on phones. However, it is important to add that it is a subjective choice and one that's based purely on how it makes me feel about the phone's design. However, many smartphone makers push the idea of curved displays as the use of superior display tech, one that not only looks better but also adds value in terms of usage of the phone.

But as anyone who has used a curved display phone would tell you, such claims are very far from reality. Curved display phones can be a nuisance to sue, with the internet filled with user reviews that explain just how these curved panels can make using and gripping phones difficult.

Curved displays make the phone's panel less durable, and leave your phone's panel more susceptible to picking up cracks in case it slips out of your hand – which might we add can also be a consequence of the curved panel making the phone more slippery in the hand. It also makes the phone more prone to accidental touches, and are an absolute no-no if you plan on gaming a lot on your phone. d